

03 · JOINT CONDITION

Knee Pain Recovery Protocol

A structured rehab framework for mild knee pain — restoring range of motion, strength, and confidence in the joint.

AUTHORED BY

Đorđe Ignjatović

Sport Rehabilitation Specialist

RECOVERY WINDOW

4 – 8 weeks (typical)

THE THREE-PHASE PROTOCOL

1

PHASE ONE

Acute Management

0 – 72 HOURS

- Elevate the leg so the knee sits above heart level
- Compress the knee with an elastic bandage
- Cryotherapy (cold application) to reduce inflammation
- Gently activate the quadriceps with light, controlled movement
- Topical cooling cream and anti-swelling / anti-hematoma cream

2

PHASE TWO

Mobility & Activation

SUBACUTE PHASE

- Gradually restore range of motion
- Stronger, more controlled quadriceps activation
- Knee-joint stabilization exercises
- Cryotherapy, compression, and creams as needed

3

PHASE THREE

Strength & Performance

FINAL PHASE

- Strengthen the entire joint apparatus
- Targeted strength exercises for the lower limb
- Agility and balance training
- Explosive / plyometric work



RED FLAGS — WHEN TO STOP & SEEK SPECIALIST CARE

The knee is a complex joint — both to diagnose and to rehabilitate — so take these recommendations seriously. Stop training if pain worsens, swelling persists, there is no improvement after 5–7 days, or you feel instability in the joint.

Need a tailored program?

Get in touch for a personalized recovery and rehabilitation plan.

info@sportcaremed.com